NEIGHBOURWISE AI

Neighborhood Intelligence Report

Dorchester

Boston, Massachusetts

72.2

out of 100 · **SOLID CHOICE**

▲ TOP STRENGTH	**Schools**
▼ TOP WEAKNESS	**Universities**

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Dorchester, a vibrant and diverse neighborhood nestled in the heart of Boston, Massachusetts, offers a unique blend of urban living with a strong community feel. With a master score of 72.2 out of 100, it's a solid choice for those seeking a balance of city life and neighborhood charm. Dorchester's top strength lies in its excellent schools, scoring a perfect 100, making it an ideal choice for families and individuals prioritizing quality education. However, its lower score in universities (47.5) suggests that it may not be the first choice for those seeking a college town atmosphere.

The neighborhood's transit score of 97.0 is a testament to its exceptional public transportation system, providing easy access to downtown Boston and beyond. This, coupled with its impressive Bluebikes score of 99.5, makes Dorchester a commuter's paradise. The housing score of 74.9 indicates a decent range of options, from historic single-family homes to modern apartments, suitable for a variety of budgets and lifestyles. However, with a safety score of 47.6, potential residents should be aware of the need for vigilance, particularly in certain areas.

Dorchester's grocery score of 83.9 reflects a good selection of stores for daily needs, but its restaurant score of 49.7 suggests a relatively limited dining scene. Healthcare facilities are adequate, scoring 61.4, but there's room for improvement. In summary, Dorchester is a solid choice for families and commuters who value quality education and easy transit, but it may not be the best fit for those seeking a robust dining scene or a college town vibe. Its unique character and diversity make it a neighborhood worth considering for those looking to call Boston home.

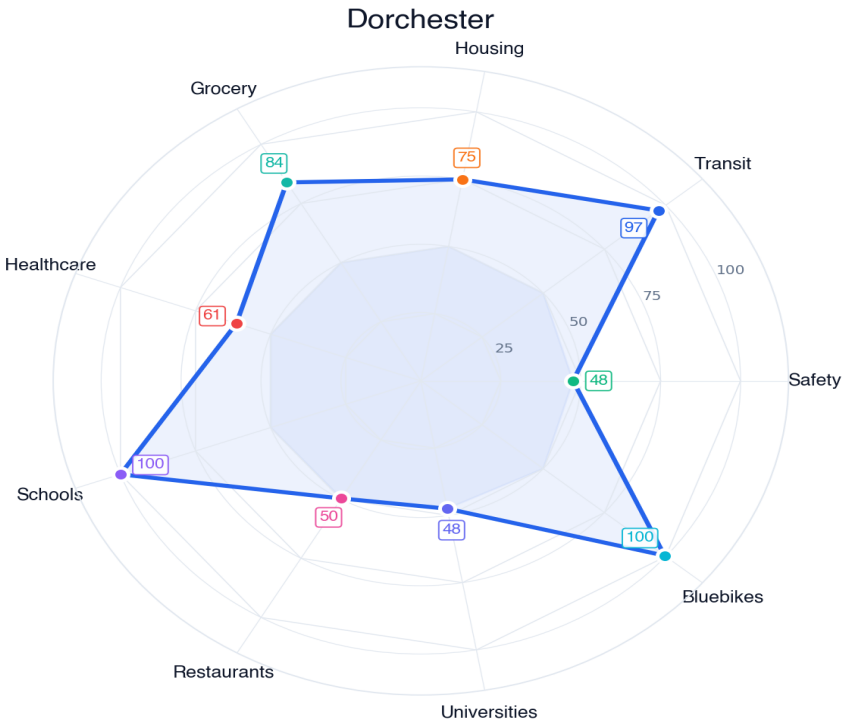
DOMAIN SCORECARD

DOMAIN	SCORE	GRADE
Safety	47.6	Moderate
Transit	97.0	Excellent
Housing	74.9	Affordable
Grocery	83.9	Abundant
Healthcare	61.4	Good
Schools	100.0	Excellent
Restaurants	49.7	Moderate
Universities	47.5	Moderate

Bluebikes	99.5	Excellent

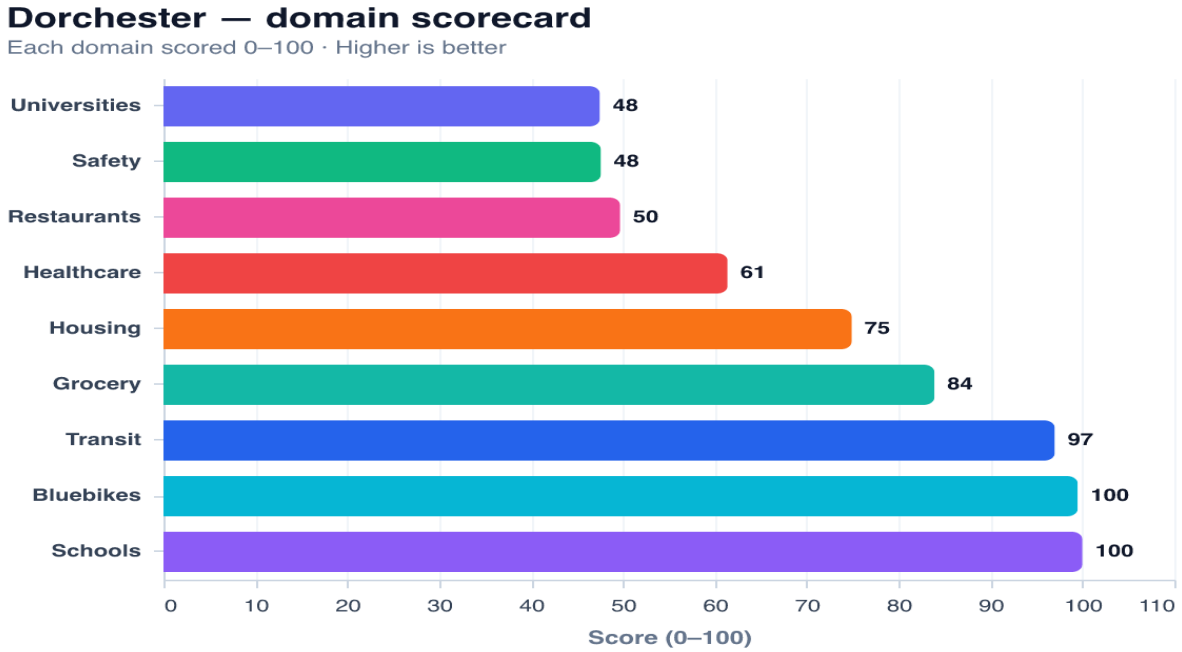
VISUAL ANALYSIS

Domain Radar



Each spoke represents one of the 9 scored domains (0–100).

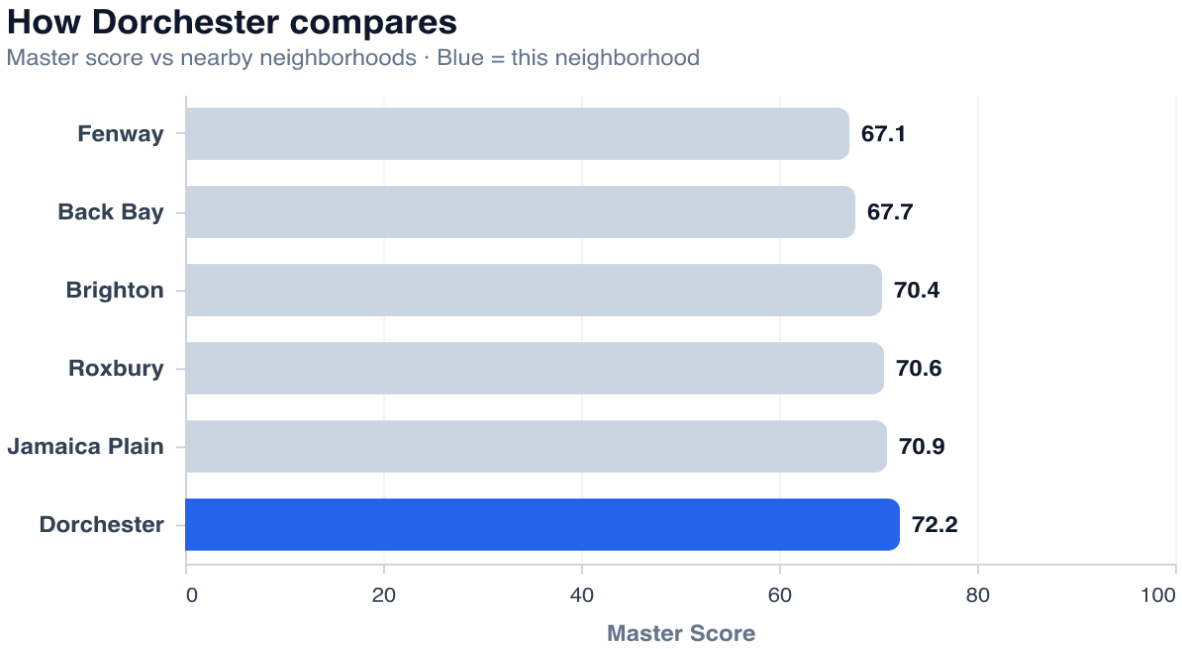
All Domain Scores



Color-coded by domain · Higher bars = stronger performance.

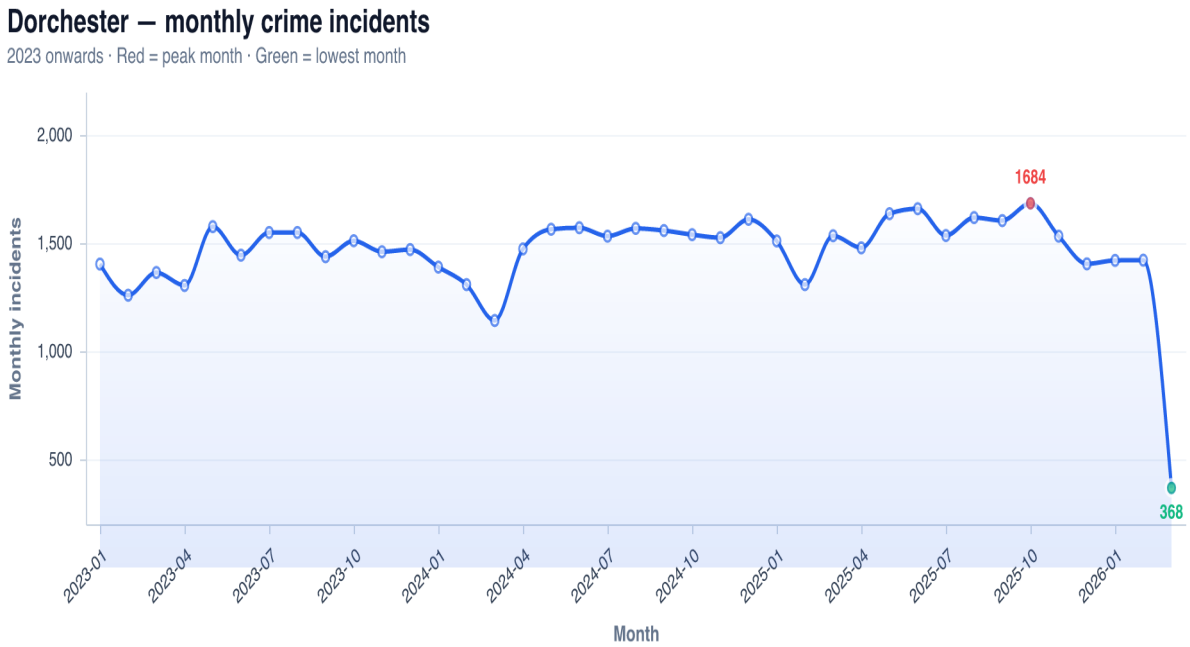
COMPARISON & TRENDS

Neighborhood Comparison



Blue bar = this neighborhood · Compared to 5 nearest by master score.

Crime Trend



Monthly incidents from 2023 · Red = peak · Green = lowest.

DOMAIN ANALYSIS

● Safety

In Dorchester, a neighborhood within Boston, Massachusetts, safety is a moderate concern with a score of 47.6 out of 100. The most common police service call is to investigate a person, however, the most prevalent actual crime type is property crime, accounting for 19.23% of all incidents. There has been a slight increase of 2.83% in total incidents year over year, with violent crimes representing a relatively small proportion at 1.14%. Residents and visitors should remain vigilant, particularly regarding property crimes, given the high incident rate of 7793.69 per square mile.

● Transit

Dorchester, a vibrant neighborhood in Boston, boasts an excellent transit score of 97.0, making it a commuter's paradise. The area is served by the Mattapan Line and the Red Line for rapid transit, connecting residents to key destinations such as Downtown Boston and Quincy Center. In addition, Dorchester offers an extensive network of bus routes, including the Fairmount Line and various loops, providing access to local attractions like the Franklin Park Zoo and the John F. Kennedy Presidential Library and Museum. With a total of 333 stops, including 7 rapid transit stops and 325 bus stops, 96.1% of which are wheelchair accessible, Dorchester's public transportation system is both comprehensive and inclusive.

Restaurants

Dorchester, a neighborhood in Boston, Massachusetts, offers a moderate restaurant scene with a diverse range of cuisines, from American and Italian to Asian and Caribbean. With a density of 109.74 restaurants per square mile, diners have ample choices among its 800 establishments, although the quality varies with only 30.5% rated as high quality. The area caters to various budgets with a good mix of budget, mid-range, and upscale options, and nearly 80% of the restaurants offer delivery services.

Universities

Dorchester, a neighborhood in Boston, Massachusetts, offers moderate access to education with a score of 47.5 out of 100. The area hosts two educational institutions: Jupiter Beauty Academy, a private vocational school, and the University of Massachusetts Boston, a public research university. The University of Massachusetts Boston provides opportunities for higher education, including bachelor's and doctorate degrees, and also offers campus housing for students.

LIFESTYLE & CHARACTER

Dorchester, a vibrant neighborhood in Boston, Massachusetts, carries a complex history that has shaped its unique character. The neighborhood's residential patterns were influenced by past practices such as redlining and restrictive covenants, which led to a segregated community. Despite the changes in policies during the 1960s, the local plans to address lending disparities further increased segregation, restricting low-interest loans to areas like Mattapan and parts of Dorchester, where the majority of Black and Latinx residents live today. This history has resulted in a diverse and resilient community, marked by a strong sense of cultural identity.

Daily life in Dorchester is characterized by longer commute times, with many residents traveling more than 60 minutes to work, the highest in the city. This is particularly true for the predominantly Black and Latinx neighborhoods, revealing a lack of access to public transportation for a large portion of Boston's communities of color. Despite its relative proximity to employment centers, Dorchester, along with Mattapan and Roxbury, is primarily served by buses, leading to extended travel times. These transit challenges, voiced by residents at community meetings, are a significant aspect of the neighborhood's daily life. Yet, the community's spirit remains undeterred, making Dorchester a neighborhood of resilience and perseverance.

WHO SHOULD LIVE HERE?

Paragraph 1: The neighborhood of Dorchester in Boston, Massachusetts appears to be an ideal fit for families, primarily due to its exceptional scores in the categories of Schools and Transit. With a perfect score of 100.0 in Schools, it is evident that the area boasts high-quality educational institutions, making it an attractive choice for families with school-aged children. Additionally, the impressive Transit score of 97.0 suggests that the neighborhood has excellent public transportation options, which can be beneficial for families who prefer not to rely heavily on personal vehicles or for those with teenagers who may be utilizing public transit for commuting to school or part-time jobs. Paragraph 2: On the other hand, young professionals and retirees may want to consider other neighborhoods. Despite the excellent transit options, the area's lower scores in categories such as Safety (47.6), Restaurants (49.7), and Universities (47.5) might be less appealing to young professionals who typically seek vibrant social scenes and proximity to higher education institutions. Similarly, retirees might find the lower Safety and Healthcare scores (61.4) concerning, as these factors often become more critical considerations in their choice of residence. Therefore, both young professionals and retirees may find neighborhoods with higher scores in these categories more suitable for their respective lifestyles and needs.